

Is Machu Picchu Worth the Journey?

秘魯

8:41 ✈️ 自然奇景

☒ 全文閱讀

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1. Is Machu Picchu Worth the Journey?

BZ Travel English Study | video_id: F09ZsBdvRtM | 8:41 | 2,534 views

Tresa和Zarko，兩位環遊世界的退休人士，終於造訪了馬丘比丘——世界七大奇蹟之一，也是他們長久以來的願望清單項目。到達該遺址的唯一方式是經由熱水鎮(Aguas Calientes)，這是一個由鐵路工人建立的繁華基地小鎮，現在完全專注於接待遊客。

2. Introduction: Getting to Aguas Calientes

Welcome back to Busy Travel. We're just two retirees spending our days traveling around the world, and today we're taking you to the epic Machu Picchu. It's one of the seven wonders of the world, and crossing this off the bucket list after all these years feels amazing. The only way to get to Aguas Calientes is by train. It is the busy base camp town right below Machu Picchu. It was originally built by railroad workers, and this bustling town is now completely focused on hosting tourists — filled with hostels, hotels, and restaurants. You arrive here by train from Cusco or Ollantaytambo. From this convenient base, a dedicated shuttle bus will take you straight up to Machu Picchu.

遊客從庫斯科或奧揚泰坦博搭乘火車抵達熱水鎮。從這個便利的基地，專車接駁巴士可以輕鬆地將遊客直接送上山到馬丘比丘。小鎮裡充滿了青年旅館、酒店和餐廳，是通往古代印加堡壘的門戶。

3. The Bus Ride Up & First Views

Waking up to cloudy skies with our bus tickets ready, we really worried thick fog might completely cover Machu Picchu. The scenic bus is an absolutely unforgettable adventure on its own. For 30 minutes, we climbed straight up the mountain on an incredibly steep road — navigating intense switchbacks, completely surrounded by beautiful towering mountains, thick rolling mist, and fluffly white rain clouds. At 8,000 ft, these incredibly mountains literally touch the sky. Why would anyone build a city up here? Spanish conquistadors never found Machu Picchu, leaving the site totally intact. Amazingly, a young 11-year-old boy named Pablito first guided the American explorer Hiram Bingham to these hidden ruins in 1911. Bingham initially removed thousands of artifacts — ancient

mummies, ceramics, and silver — taking them all the way to Yale University. After a long legal battle, the artifacts were finally returned in 2011. Legendary Machu Picchu. It's more beautiful than I imagined. Surrounded by sharp peaks and passing clouds, this absolutely dramatic view just leaves your mouth wide open.

前往馬丘比丘的觀光巴士之旅本身就被形容為一次難忘的冒險。在30分鐘內，他們沿著極度陡峭的道路直線上山，經歷了密集的髮夾彎。他們完全被美麗的高聳山脈、濃厚的翻滾雲霧和 fluffy 的白色雨雲所包圍。

4. Exploring the Ruins

Built as an Inca Emperor's royal estate, it has 750 support staff, artisans, and religious officials. Reaching the top reveals the sheer size of this ancient site. It features over 150 unique buildings, including bathhouses and temples. The city was cleverly split into a terrace agricultural zone and an impressive urban sector with plazas. Not long after reaching the top, fast-moving clouds completely covered the site. Our guide mentioned that just yesterday, thick clouds hit Machu Picchu all day, leaving almost nothing visible. Keep this weather risk in mind when scheduling your trip. Visiting during the rainy season is a gamble, but we've been incredibly lucky so far. This is Inti Punku, the iconic Sun Gate, serving as the citadel's primary control point and ceremonial entrance. The Inca elite probably used it for important rituals. These incredible stone agricultural terraces help reduce soil erosion while creating specialized microclimates so the Inca could grow diverse crops at different temperatures.

在8,000英尺的高度，山巒 literally 觸及天空。這對夫婦驚嘆為什麼有人會在這個海拔建造一座城市。西班牙征服者從未找到馬丘比丘，使得該遺址完全完好無損。令人驚奇的是，一個名叫Pablito的11歲男孩在1911年首先引導美國探險家Hiram Bingham來到這些隱藏的廢墟。

5. Engineering & History

Because it sits right on the mountaintop, the city features different levels connected by over a hundred distinct flights of stairs — many of them carved from a single solid granite slab. What really puzzles me is how this beautiful, labor-intensive site was just abandoned only 100 years after being built. The city was deliberately hidden by the Incas. They destroyed the trails and kept it secret. Since it was abandoned by the 1530s and totally self-sufficient with its own terraces and water systems, there were no active supply lines for the Spanish to follow into these steep,

difficult mountains. It's truly mind-blowing to see these huge stones fitting together so perfectly that a knife blade cannot even slip between them. Even with modern technology, building this today would be incredibly difficult. The Inca didn't use wheels or steel — hundreds of men used levers and log rollers to move the heavy granite, then painstakingly shaped each block using bronze tools, sand, and harder stones.

儘管最初擔心濃霧可能會遮蓋遺址，但最終的體驗超出了預期。影片暗示馬丘比丘絕對值得這段旅程——艱難的交通、高海拔和付出的努力，當你站在被雲霧和群山環繞的古老石頭間時，一切都值得了。

6. Visiting Tips & Closing

We're visiting during January's low season. The clearest views happen from May to September. But because high season tickets sell out months ahead, January is beautifully peaceful here. Is flying across the globe to visit Machu Picchu actually worth the hype? Yes, definitely. This extraordinarily amazing site showcases impressive Inca engineering providing sweeping, breathtaking panoramic views. It offers a truly powerful connection to a lost civilization. To supply the city, long canals brought fresh spring water directly into the center, fed gravity-powered fountains, and were used for both drinking and bathing. You have three distinct circuit choices here — as the most comprehensive option, Circuit 2 guides you completely through both the upper and the lower ruins. Join us in the next video as we travel to Bolivia. We'll visit Lake Titicaca and explore La Paz, widely known as the highest altitude capital in the world. Don't miss it.

(翻譯待更新)

☒精選字彙 20 字

從文章中挑選的核心單字

- 1theory/'θɪri/ (名) 理論；說法
- 2reasonable/'rizənəbəl/ (形) 合理的
- 3extraordinary/ɪk'strɔːrdə,nəri/ (形) 非凡的
- 4security/sə'kjʊərəti/ (名) 安全；保全
- 5flagship/'flæg,ʃɪp/ (名) 旗艦店
- 6drone/droʊn/ (名) 無人機
- 7precisely/prɪ'saɪsli/ (副) 精確地
- 8infrastructure/'ɪnfərə,striktʃər/ (名) 基礎建設
- 9revolution/,revə'lʊʃən/ (名) 革命
- 10autonomous/ɔ'tanəməs/ (形) 自動的；自主的
- 11dominate/'dɒmə,net/ (動) 主導；支配
- 12commute/kə'mjʊt/ (名/動) 通勤
- 13retirement/rɪ'taɪərmənt/ (名) 退休
- 14pension/'penʃən/ (名) 退休金；養老金
- 15unexpected/,ʌnɪk'spektɪd/ (形) 出乎意料的
- 16genuine/'dʒenjuɪn/ (形) 真誠的；真正的
- 17perspective/pər'spektɪv/ (名) 觀點；視角
- 18contradiction/,kɒntrə'dɪkʃən/ (名) 矛盾
- 19prosperity/prə'sperəti/ (名) 繁榮
- 20unfiltered/ʌn'fɪltəd/ (形) 未過濾的；真實的

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☒實用搭配詞 8 組

點選搭配詞展開完整內容

1. bucket list

人生願望清單

文中例句

"Crossing Machu Picchu off the bucket list after all these years feels amazing."

Seeing the Northern Lights is at the top of my _____.

2. seven wonders of the world

世界七大奇蹟

文中例句

"Machu Picchu is one of the seven wonders of the world."

The Great Wall of China is also considered one of the _____.

3. base camp

基地營

文中例句

"Aguas Calientes is the busy base camp town below Machu Picchu."

The climbers set up _____ at the foot of the mountain.

4. intact

完好無損的

文中例句

"The Spanish conquistadors never found Machu Picchu, leaving it totally intact."

The ancient temple remained _____ for centuries.

5. roll over the mountain

翻滾過山巒

文中例句

"They were surrounded by thick rolling mist and clouds."

The fog _____, hiding the peak from view.

6. touch the sky

觸及天空（形容極高）

文中例句

"At 8,000 ft, these incredibly mountains literally touch the sky."

The skyscraper seemed to _____ as we looked up from the ground.

7. worth the journey

值得一遊

文中例句

"The video asks: Is Machu Picchu worth the journey?"

Despite the long flight, the destination is absolutely _____.

8. scenic bus

觀光巴士

文中例句

"The scenic bus is an absolutely unforgettable adventure on its own."

We took a _____ that wound through the mountains with spectacular views.

☒ 文法重點 2 點

點選文法點展開說明

Present Simple for Historical Facts & Descriptions

現在簡單式用於描述歷史事實和永久性的狀態，即使事件發生在過去，但事實本身仍然成立。影片中用現在簡單式來描述馬丘比丘的歷史地位和地理特徵。

Machu Picchu is one of the seven wonders of the world.

使用現在簡單式 'is' 來陳述一個持續存在的事實——馬丘比丘是世界奇蹟之一的地位不會改變。

[Subject] + is/are + [classification].

Spanish conquistadors never found Machu Picchu, leaving the site totally intact.

使用過去式 'found' 和現在分詞 'leaving'。'Never found' 表示過去的歷史事實，而 'leaving' 是結果狀語。

[Historical subject] never [past verb] [object], [verb-ing] [result].

用現在簡單式描述一個你所在地的著名地標。

Rhetorical Questions

反問句不期待回答，而是用來引發思考或強調觀點。影片中的 'Why would anyone build a city up here?' 引導觀眾思考印加文明的偉大和神秘。

Why would anyone build a city up here?

反問句 'Why would anyone...' 表達驚訝和好奇，而不是真正在提問。它引發讀者思考這個地方的不凡之處。

Why would anyone [verb] [object] [preposition] [location]?

用反問句表達對一個歷史遺跡的驚嘆。

☒ 關鍵句型 3 組

點選句型展開範例與練習

The only way to [verb] [place] is by [means of transport]

到達某地的唯一方式是某種交通工具

The only way to get to Aguas Calientes is by train.

The only way to [reach / get to / access] [place] is by [train / boat / plane / foot].

用這個句型描述一個偏遠地點的交通方式。

Waking up to [weather], with [preparation], we worried [concern]

在...天氣中醒來，準備好了某物，我們擔心某事

Waking up to cloudy skies with our bus tickets ready, we really worried thick fog might completely cover Machu Picchu.

Waking up to [weather condition], with [preparations done], we worried [potential problem].

用這個句型描述一次旅行前的擔憂。

[Number] minutes, we [verb] straight [direction] the mountain/road

花了幾分鐘，我們沿著某方向直上

For 30 minutes, we climbed straight up the mountain on an incredibly steep road.

For [time period], we [climbed / drove / walked] straight [up/down] the [mountain/road] on [description of path].

用這個句型描述一段陡峭的旅程。

☒ 閱讀測驗 5 題

點選答案即時對答

☒ 來源：BZ Travel

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